

Stop losing money in your messy DMs! 🚨

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 01, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/j6tPAuQaQNw> Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, who has coached 15,000+ online fitness entrepreneurs, explains why top earners (50–100K/month) prioritize DM management systems over follower growth, and walks through a 5-stage Go High Level pipeline.

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🧠 The Core Mindset Shift: Systems Over Following 0:00

- Most people believe growing their follower count is the key to making money online
 - Carter says this is wrong — the real lever is building operational systems
- His data point: he has taught **over 15,000 people** how to grow online fitness businesses
 - This gives him a direct comparison between high and low earners at scale
- The gap in results:
 - Top students earn **50–100K per month**
 - Lower-performing students earn **5–10K per month**
 - The primary differentiator is not audience size — it is how they manage leads

📁 The Problem: Unstructured Instagram DMs 0:22

- The common mistake: running the entire business through Instagram DMs with no system, no pipeline, and no strategy
- A specific failure scenario:
 - A video goes viral and floods the inbox with new messages
 - Leads that were already being nurtured get pushed down in the DM thread
 - Those warm leads are forgotten — money is lost
- Key insight: "You're letting a lot of money slip through the cracks"
- This problem is especially damaging for smaller accounts

- With a small following, every single lead matters more — you cannot afford to lose any

The Solution: Go High Level + 5-Stage Pipeline 0:22

- Tool recommended: **Go High Level** (GHL), synced directly to your Instagram account
- GHL allows you to set up automations that sort DMs into structured stages
- Carter's recommended 5-stage pipeline:
 - Stage 1 — **New Lead**: freshly arrived, uncontacted prospects
 - Stage 2 — **Warm Lead**: prospects who have been engaged and are showing interest
 - Stage 3 — **Booked Call**: leads who have scheduled a sales or discovery call
 - Stage 4 — **Follow Up**: leads who need a follow-up touch after a call or lack of response
 - Stage 5 — **Close**: leads who have converted into paying clients
- You can message leads directly from inside Go High Level — no need to go back into Instagram DMs
- Result: all leads have structure and are tracked, rather than buried in a chaotic Instagram inbox

Scaling and Next Steps 0:45

- As the business grows, GHL enables team delegation
 - Add employees to your Go High Level account
 - They can nurture leads and book calls on your behalf without you being in the DMs
- Carter emphasizes this system is not just for advanced operators
 - "Even if you're just starting out, you need to do this"
 - Small followings mean every lead is precious — structured management is essential from day one
- Call to action: Comment "**GHL**" on the video to receive a link for a **free 30-day trial** of Go High Level